

DOES THIS SECTION EVEN NEED AN INTRODUCTION? FROM COMPUTERS TO MOBILES, AND HEADPHONES TO GPUs, IT'S ALL HERE...

THIS MONTH IN TECH: We cover the advancements in the autonomous car research and technology, and delve into the origins of cryptocurrency. We also have a comprehensive guide on how to pick a BaaS for your app.



Tesla no longer among "Safest Cars"

Swedish insurance firm, Folksam, dropped Tesla from their annual list of the "Safest Cars" because there simply weren't enough crashes over the entire year for enough data to be collected.

<https://dgit.in/GottaCrashMore>

WHAT'S NEW

Amazon reveals 14 new Alexa devices

Amazon's Devices Event was more elaborate this year with 14 new devices announced, with some new product categories. First among the refreshes include the 3rd Gen Echo Dot which now has a clock, a new Echo with the built-in hub feature removed and retailing at a lower price. The built-in hub is now being included with the Echo Studio, which is a little expensive. Among the ones with screens, there is the Echo Show 8 which is a minor upgrade. Among the new devices are the Echo Flex, a wall plug with a speaker, microphone and USB port, the Echo Loop, an Alexa enabled ring that you can use to talk to your Echo devices. To go with the flex, Amazon also



unveiled Echo Buds True Wireless Earphones and Echo Frames which are simple frames with directional microphones. On the

security front, Amazon unveiled the Ring Stick-Up Cam and Ring Indoor Cam. Lastly, Amazon also introduced a Mesh Wi-Fi solution by the name of Eero. One of the more interesting announcements made was around improving Alexa's voice and making it sound less robotic and more natural.

<https://dgit.in/Amazon2019>

Apple announces new iPhones, Watch, iPad and Arcade

Apple went beyond hardware with this year's launch event. They announced the new iPhone 11, 11 Pro and 11 Pro Max with the improved A13 processor that supposedly improves performance by 20% and the 11 Pro Max packs a triple camera setup. Then comes the 10.2-inch 7th Generation iPad which still has the older A10 Fusion processor. The Watch got refreshed with the new Series 5 with an always-on display that can drop to 1 Hz to



save battery life and incorporates hearing, heart and movement, and menstrual-cycle tracking. The announcement that garnered most of the eyeballs was the Apple Arcade subscription service

which is \$4.99/month service that the whole family can share. Arcade will see multiple top-tier games launched every month. Apple TV Plus was the other subscription service and it's being given to all folks buying any of the new devices for free for one year. Apple showcased nine new titles that would be made available at launch in November. Incidentally, this was the first launch event to be streamed live on YouTube.

<https://dgit.in/Apple2019>



Facebook "standards" don't apply to politicians

Facebook went on the record in a blog post stating that politicians are exempt from the platform's hate speech and fact checking standards. Also, the "Newsworthiness" of a post will be determined by weighing the public interest value. <https://dgit.in/FbPoliStandard>



Wi-Fi 6 certification program begins

The Wi-Fi Alliance is finally done with the Wi-Fi 6 standard and has formally opened up the certification program, which essentially means that hardware vendors can now get their SKUs certified for compliance. <https://dgit.in/WiFi6Cert>



Automatic Listening Exploitation Act

The new act introduced in the US Senate would fine companies \$40,000 for every recording made without seeking the user's permission and would give the user the right to demand the deletion of said recordings. <https://dgit.in/StopListening>